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Machine learning method and named entity recognition apparatus

Abstract

A computer divides a character string included in text data into a plurality of tokens. The computer searches, by performing matching processing between a token string indicating a specific number of consecutive tokens among the plurality of tokens and dictionary information including a plurality of named entities, the plurality of named entities for a similar named entity whose similarity to the token string is equal to or more than a threshold. The computer converts matching information indicating a result of the matching processing between the token string and the similar named entity into first vector data. The computer generates input data by using a plurality of pieces of vector data converted from the plurality of tokens and the first vector data. The computer generates a named entity recognition model that detects a named entity by performing machine learning using the input data.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application is a continuation application of International Application PCT/JP2020/017488 filed on Apr. 23, 2020 which designated the U.S., the entire contents of which are incorporated herein by reference.

FIELD

(1) The embodiments discussed herein relate to a machine learning technique.

BACKGROUND

(2) Named entity recognition (NER) is one technique for natural language processing. This named entity recognition may also be referred to as named entity extraction. Named entities include proper nouns such as personal names, organization names, and place names. In the named entity recognition, named entities are detected from text, and classes of the detected named entities are determined. There are cases in which the result of the named entity recognition is used as input for other tasks, such as relationship extraction for determining a relationship between words and entity linking for linking named entities in text with information in a knowledge database.

(3) In the named entity recognition, there are cases in which an unknown word not listed in an existing dictionary needs to be recognized as a named entity. This situation may occur when a named entity, which is a technical term, is detected from text in a specific technical field. For example, the named entity recognition is performed in an attempt to detect named entities, such as gene names, drug names, and disease names, from text in the biomedical field. In the biomedical

field, gene names and drug names are often compound words, and new gene names and drug names that are not listed in existing technical term dictionaries often appear in text.

(4) As a method relating to the named entity recognition for unknown words, there has been proposed a dictionary expansion technique using approximate string matching. For example, there has been proposed a technique in which character string editing, such as insertion, deletion, or replacement of characters, is performed on a gene name registered in a dictionary to generate a candidate for another gene name. In addition, there has been proposed a technique in which a predetermined preceding keyword or subsequent keyword is added to a gene name registered in a dictionary to generate a candidate for another gene name.

(5) In addition, as a method relating to the named entity recognition for unknown words, there has been proposed a machine learning model technique using exact string matching. For example, there has been proposed a technique in which words included in text are converted into word vectors in distributed representation, and confidence factors of named entity classes are calculated from the word vectors by using a multi-layer neural network including a bidirectional long short term memory (LSTM). In this proposed technique, for the words registered in a dictionary, auxiliary information indicating exact match with the dictionary is entered into the multi-layer neural network together with the word vectors. Because a confidence factor of a named entity class is also calculated for an unknown word, an unknown named entity could be detected by this technique.

(6) See, for example, the following documents: Yoshimasa Tsuruoka and Jun'ichi Tsujii, "Improving the performance of dictionary-based approaches in protein name recognition", Journal of Biomedical Informatics, Volume 37 Issue 6, pp. 461-470, December 2004 Zhihao Yang, Hongfei Lin and Yanpeng Li, "Exploiting the performance of dictionary-based bio-entity name recognition in biomedical literature", Computational Biology and Chemistry, Volume 32 Issue 4, pp. 287-291, August 2008 Alexandre Passos, Vineet Kumar and Andrew McCallum, "Lexicon Infused Phrase Embeddings for Named Entity Resolution", Proc. of the 18th Conference on Computational Natural Language Learning, pp. 78-86, June 2014 Jingjing Xu, Ji Wen, Xu Sun and Qi Su, "A Discourse-Level Named Entity Recognition and Relation Extraction Dataset for Chinese Literature Text", arXiv:1711.07010, 19 Nov. 2017

SUMMARY

(7) In an aspect, there is provided a non-transitory computer-readable recording medium storing therein a computer program that causes a computer to execute a process including: dividing a character string included in text data into a plurality of tokens; searching, by performing matching processing between a token string indicating a specific number of consecutive tokens among the plurality of tokens and dictionary information including a plurality of named entities, the plurality of named entities for a similar named entity whose similarity to the token string is equal to or more than a threshold; converting matching information indicating a result of the matching processing between the token string and the similar named entity into first vector data; generating input data by using a plurality of pieces of vector data converted from the plurality of tokens and the first vector data; and generating a named entity recognition model that detects a named entity by performing machine learning using the input data.

(8) The object and advantages of the invention will be realized and attained by means of the elements and combinations particularly pointed out in the claims.

(9) It is to be understood that both the foregoing general description and the following detailed description are exemplary and explanatory and are not restrictive of the invention.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 illustrates a machine learning apparatus according to a first embodiment;

- (2) FIG. 2 illustrates a named entity recognition apparatus according to a second embodiment;
- (3) FIG. 3 illustrates a hardware example of a machine learning apparatus according to a third embodiment;
- (4) FIG. 4 illustrates a data flow example of named entity recognition;
- (5) FIG. 5 illustrates an example of a named entity dictionary;
- (6) FIG. 6 illustrates an example of a matching pattern dictionary;
- (7) FIG. 7 illustrates a generation example of a matching vector;
- (8) FIG. 8 illustrates examples of named entity recognition results;
- (9) FIG. 9 is a block diagram illustrating a functional example of the machine learning apparatus;
- (10) FIG. 10 is a flowchart illustrating an example of a procedure for input data generation;
- (11) FIG. 11 is a flowchart illustrating an example of a procedure for model generation; and
- (12) FIG. 12 is a flowchart illustrating an example of a procedure for named entity recognition.

DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

(13) The conventional dictionary expansion technique using approximate string matching increases recognizable named entities in accordance with a predetermined expansion rule. However, because the dictionary expansion in accordance with a predetermined expansion rule does not comprehensively cover unknown named entities, there is a limit to the improvement in recognition accuracy. In addition, the conventional machine learning model technique using exact string matching enables recognition of unknown named entities to some extent while ensuring the accuracy in recognizing the known named entities registered in a dictionary. However, in this technique, only the auxiliary information about the known named entities that exactly match the dictionary is provided. Thus, there is a limit to the improvement in the accuracy of recognizing unknown named entities.

(14) Hereinafter, the present embodiments will be described with reference to drawings. A first embodiment will be described. FIG. 1 illustrates a machine learning apparatus according to the first embodiment. The machine learning apparatus **10** generates a named entity recognition model for detecting named entities from input text data by performing machine learning. The machine learning apparatus **10** may be a client apparatus or a server apparatus. The machine learning apparatus **10** may be referred to as a computer or an information processing apparatus. Named entity recognition using a generated named entity recognition model may be performed by the machine learning apparatus **10** or another information processing apparatus.

(15) The machine learning apparatus **10** includes a storage unit **11** and a control unit **12**. The storage unit **11** may be a volatile semiconductor memory such as a random access memory (RAM) or a non-volatile storage such as a hard disk drive (HDD) or a flash memory. The control unit **12** is, for example, a processor such as a central processing unit (CPU), a graphics processing unit (GPU), or a digital signal processor (DSP). The control unit **12** may include an application-specific electronic circuit such as application-specific integrated circuit (ASIC) or a field programmable gate array (FPGA). The processor executes a program stored in a memory such as a RAM (which may be the storage unit **11**). A group of processors may be referred to as a “multiprocessor” or simply a “processor”.

(16) The storage unit **11** stores text data **13** and dictionary information **14**.

(17) The text data **13** includes a character string representing a sentence written in natural language. The text data **13** is, for example, a document in a specific technical field, such as an academic paper in the biomedical field. The text data **13** is used as training data for machine learning. Thus, correct labels relating to named entities are assigned to the text data **13**. For example, if a named entity is included in the text data **13**, a tag indicating the named entity or a tag indicating a named entity class is assigned to the named entity. These correct labels are manually assigned in advance, for example.

(18) The dictionary information **14** is a named entity dictionary in which a plurality of known named entities are listed. For example, the dictionary information **14** includes technical named

entities such as gene names, drug names, and disease names. The dictionary information **14** may include classes to which the individual named entities belong. However, there may be a case in which the dictionary information **14** does not cover all named entities. The text data **13** may include named entities listed in the dictionary information **14** and may include named entities not listed in the dictionary information **14**. Those named entities not listed in the dictionary information **14** may be referred to as unknown named entities or unknown words.

(19) The control unit **12** generates a named entity recognition model **18** by performing machine learning as follows.

(20) First, the control unit **12** divides a character string included in the text data **13** into a plurality of tokens. The character string is divided into these tokens by using, for example, a natural language processing technique such as morphological analysis. The individual token is a character string having a linguistic meaning and may be a word or a linguistic unit smaller than a word. A named entity may be a compound word. Thus, one token may form one named entity, and one token string including two or more tokens may form one named entity.

(21) For example, a token string (w.sub.3, w.sub.4, w.sub.5) in the text data **13** forms one named entity. In the dictionary information **14**, a token string (w.sub.1, w.sub.2, w'.sub.3) is listed as one named entity, and a token string (w.sub.3, w'.sub.4) is listed as another named entity.

(22) The control unit **12** extracts a token string **13a** indicating a specific number of consecutive tokens from the text data **13**. The specific number is, for example, two or more. The token string **13a** including n tokens may be referred to as an n-gram. The control unit **12** may extract two or more token strings, each of which is formed by the same number n of tokens, from the text data **13**. The control unit **12** may extract two or more token strings, each of which is formed by a different number n of tokens from the text data **13**. The control unit **12** performs matching processing between the token string **13a** and the dictionary information **14**. In the matching processing, the control unit **12** compares each of the plurality of named entities included in the dictionary information **14** with the token string **13a**.

(23) In the matching processing, so-called approximate string matching is performed. The control unit **12** searches the plurality of named entities included in the dictionary information **14** for a named entity whose similarity to the token string **13a** is equal to or more than a threshold. The control unit **12** determines the retrieved named entity as a similar named entity **14a**. For example, the similarity between the token string **13a** and a named entity may be the inverse number of an edit distance (Levenshtein distance) calculated between the token string **13a** and the named entity. In this case, the control unit **12** may calculate an edit distance between the token string **13a** and the individual named entity and determine a named entity having an edit distance equal to or less than a threshold as the similar named entity **14a**. The edit distance is the number of times of addition, replacement, or deletion of one character performed to match a certain named entity with the token string **13a**. The edit distance may be calculated by dynamic programming.

(24) The token string **13a** and the similar named entity **14a** may exactly match with each other or may be similar to each other. Two or more similar entities may be retrieved for the token string **13a**. For example, when the token string **13a** is (w.sub.3, w.sub.4), the control unit **12** determines that a token string (w.sub.1, w.sub.2, w'.sub.3) included in the dictionary information **14** is not similar to the token string **13a** and determines that a token string (w.sub.3, w'.sub.4) included in the dictionary information **14** is similar to the token string **13a**. In this case, the control unit **12** determines (w.sub.3, w'.sub.4) as the similar named entity **14a**.

(25) The control unit **12** converts matching information indicating a result of the matching processing performed between the token string **13a** and the similar named entity **14a** into vector data **16**. The matching information is generated for each token included in the token string **13a**, for example. The matching information generated for an individual token includes, for example, location information indicating a relative location of this individual token in the token string **13a**. In addition, the matching information includes, for example, matching degree information

indicating whether the token string **13a** and the similar named entity **14a** exactly match with each other. The matching information also includes, for example, class information indicating the named entity class to which the similar named entity **14a** belongs.

(26) The vector data **16** is a numerical string in which numerical values of a plurality of dimensions are listed. The vector data **16** may be distributed representation of matching information. For example, the matching information may be converted into the vector data **16** by using a trained neural network. The vector data **16** may be vector data of a large number of dimensions, e.g., vector data of 100 dimensions. The vector data **16** may have a distribution in which the numerical values of many dimensions are small and the numerical values of a small number of dimensions are large. In addition, similar matching information may be converted into similar vector data.

(27) In addition to the vector data **16**, the control unit **12** acquires a plurality of vector data converted from the plurality of tokens included in the text data **13**. In FIG. **1**, the control unit **12** acquires vector data **15** corresponding to a single token. The vector data **15** is a numerical string in which numerical values of a plurality of dimensions are listed. The vector data **15** may be distributed representation of a word. For example, the token may be converted into the vector data **15** by using a trained neural network. The trained neural network may be word2vec, for example. The vector data **15** may be vector data of a large number of dimensions, e.g., vector data of 300 dimensions. In addition, words having similar meanings may be converted into similar vector data.

(28) The control unit **12** generates input data **17** by using the vector data **15** and the vector data **16**. For example, the control unit **12** generates the vector data **15** and the vector data **16** for the token w.sub.3 in the text data **13**. Next, the control unit **12** concatenates the vector data **15** and the vector data **16** and defines the concatenated vector data as the vector data representing the token w.sub.3. To concatenate the vector data **15** and **16**, for example, the vector data **16** is placed after the vector data **15**. In this case, the number of dimensions of the concatenated vector data is a sum of the number of dimensions of the vector data **15** and the number of dimensions of the vector data **16**. Concatenated vector data may be generated for each token included in the text data **13**.

(29) Next, the control unit **12** generates a named entity recognition model **18** by performing machine learning using the input data **17**. In the machine learning, for example, the input data **17** is treated as an explanatory variable, and the individual correct label assigned to the text data **13** is treated as an objective variable. The named entity recognition model **18** receives, for example, a plurality of vector data corresponding to a plurality of tokens as input and outputs the classes to which the plurality of tokens belongs.

(30) The named entity recognition model **18** may output confidence factors representing probabilities, each of which indicates that a token belongs to an individual one of the plurality of classes. The named entity recognition model **18** may be a multi-layer neural network. For example, the control unit **12** enters the input data **17** into the named entity recognition model **18** and calculates an error by comparing the output of the named entity recognition model **18** with the corresponding correct label. The control unit **12** updates parameter values included in the named entity recognition model **18** such that the error is minimized. For example, a backpropagation method is used for updating the parameter values.

(31) The control unit **12** outputs the trained named entity recognition model **18**. For example, the control unit **12** stores the named entity recognition model **18** in a non-volatile storage. For example, the control unit **12** transfers the named entity recognition model **18** to another information processing apparatus. For example, the control unit **12** displays information about the named entity recognition model **18** on a display device.

(32) The machine learning apparatus **10** according to the first embodiment performs matching processing between the token string **13a** included in the text data **13** and the dictionary information **14** and searches for the similar named entity **14a** whose similarity is within a predetermined range. Matching information indicating a result of the matching processing between the token string **13a** and the similar named entity **14a** is converted into the vector data **16**. The input data **17** is

generated by using the vector data **15** converted from a token and the vector data **16**, and the named entity recognition model **18** is generated by performing machine learning using the input data **17**. (33) As a result, the accuracy in recognizing an unknown named entity not listed in the dictionary information **14** is improved. Because the named entity recognition model **18** is a machine learning model that estimates whether an entity is a named entity by using the vector data converted from tokens as input, the named entity recognition model **18** is able to detect an unknown named entity not listed in the dictionary information **14**. In addition, because the named entity recognition model **18** uses the matching information between the token string **13a** and the dictionary information **14** as input, the named entity recognition model **18** is able to perform the estimation in view of the known named entities listed in the dictionary information **14**.

(34) In addition, in the matching processing, not only exact string matching but also approximate string matching is performed. Thus, the accuracy in recognizing a new named entity created by modifying a known named entity is also improved. For example, many gene names and drug names in the biomedical field are compound words, and there are many similar named entities having different endings. Even when such new technical named entities are used, by using the result of approximate string matching as input, the named entity recognition model **18** achieves improved recognition accuracy.

(35) Next, a second embodiment will be described. FIG. 2 illustrates a named entity recognition apparatus according to a second embodiment. This named entity recognition apparatus **20** detects a named entity from text data by using the named entity recognition model generated by the machine learning apparatus **10** according to the first embodiment. The named entity recognition apparatus **20** may be a client apparatus or a server apparatus. The named entity recognition apparatus **20** may be referred to as a computer or an information processing apparatus. The named entity recognition apparatus **20** may be the same as the machine learning apparatus **10** according to the first embodiment.

(36) The named entity recognition apparatus **20** includes a storage unit **21** and a control unit **22**. The storage unit **21** may be a volatile semiconductor memory such as a RAM or a non-volatile storage such as an HDD or a flash memory. The control unit **22** is, for example, a processor such as a CPU, a GPU, or a DSP. The control unit **22** may include an application-specific electronic circuit such as an ASIC or an FPGA. The processor executes a program stored in a memory such as a RAM.

(37) The storage unit **21** stores text data **23**, dictionary information **24**, and a named entity recognition model **28**. The text data **23** includes a character string representing a sentence written in natural language. The text data **23** may be a document different from the text data **13** according to the first embodiment. Unlike the text data **13**, correct labels do not need to be assigned to the text data **23**. The dictionary information **24** is a named entity dictionary in which a plurality of known named entities are listed. The dictionary information **24** corresponds to the dictionary information **14** according to the first embodiment. However, the dictionary information **24** may be different from the dictionary information **14**, as long as the dictionary information **24** is of the same kind as the dictionary information **14**. For example, the dictionary information **24** belongs to the same technical field as that of the dictionary information **14**. The named entity recognition model **28** is a machine learning model that receives input data based on the text data **23** and outputs a named entity estimation result. The named entity recognition model **28** corresponds to the named entity recognition model **18** according to the first embodiment.

(38) The control unit **22** detects named entities from the text data **23** by using the named entity recognition model **28**. To detect these named entities, the control unit **22** generates input data **27** to be entered into the named entity recognition model **28**. The conversion from the text data **23** to the input data **27** is similar to the conversion from the text data **13** to the input data **17** according to the first embodiment.

(39) That is, the control unit **22** divides a character string included in the text data **23** into a

plurality of tokens and extracts a token string **23a** indicating a specific number of consecutive tokens. The control unit **22** performs matching processing between the token string **23a** and the dictionary information **24** and searches the dictionary information **24** for a similar named entity **24a** whose similarity to the token string **23a** is within a predetermined range.

(40) The control unit **22** converts matching information indicating a result of matching processing between the token string **23a** and the similar named entity **24a** into vector data **26** (second vector data). The control unit **22** generates the input data **27** by using vector data **25** (first vector data) converted from a token included in the text data **23** and the vector data **26**. For example, the control unit **22** concatenates the vector data **25** and the vector data **26** that correspond to the same token and defines the concatenated vector data as the vector data representing this token. The input data **27** includes, for example, vector data corresponding to each of the plurality of tokens.

(41) The control unit **22** enters the input data **27** into the named entity recognition model **28** and detects a named entity **29** from the text data based on the output of the named entity recognition model **28**. For example, the named entity recognition model **28** outputs tag information indicating that a token string (w.sub.3, w.sub.4, w.sub.5) in the token string (w.sub.1, w.sub.2, w.sub.3, w.sub.4, w.sub.5, w.sub.6, w.sub.7, . . .) included in the text data **23** is the named entity **29**. The named entity **29** detected by the named entity recognition model **28** may be an unknown word that is not listed in the dictionary information **24**.

(42) The named entity recognition apparatus **20** according to the second embodiment has improved accuracy in recognizing an unknown named entity not listed in the dictionary information **24**. Because the named entity recognition model **28** is a machine learning model that estimates whether an entity is a named entity by using the vector data converted from tokens as input, the named entity recognition model **28** is able to detect an unknown named entity not listed in the dictionary information **24**. In addition, because the named entity recognition model **28** uses the matching information between the token string **23a** and the dictionary information **24** as input, the named entity recognition model **28** is able to perform the estimation in view of the known named entities listed in the dictionary information **24**.

(43) In addition, in the matching processing, not only exact string matching but also approximate string matching is performed. Thus, the accuracy in recognizing a new named entity created by modifying a known named entity is also improved. For example, many gene names and drug names in the biomedical field are compound words, and there are many similar named entities having different endings. Even when such new technical named entities are used, by using the result of approximate string matching as input, the named entity recognition model **28** achieves improved recognition accuracy.

(44) Next, a third embodiment will be described. A machine learning apparatus **100** according to the third embodiment generates a named entity recognition model by performing machine learning and performs named entity recognition using the generated named entity recognition model. In the named entity recognition, a named entity that is not a common noun is detected from input text, and the category of the detected named entity is determined. According to the third embodiment, an academic paper in the biomedical field is processed as text, and technical named entities in the biomedical field such as gene names, drug names, or disease names are recognized. The machine learning apparatus **100** may be a client apparatus or a server apparatus. The machine learning apparatus **100** may be referred to as a computer or an information processing apparatus.

(45) FIG. 3 illustrates a hardware example of the machine learning apparatus according to the third embodiment. The machine learning apparatus **100** includes a CPU **101**, a RAM **102**, an HDD **103**, a GPU **104**, an input interface **105**, a media reader **106**, and a communication interface **107**. These units of the machine learning apparatus **100** are connected to a bus. The machine learning apparatus **100** corresponds to the machine learning apparatus **10** according to the first embodiment or to the named entity recognition apparatus **20** according to the second embodiment. The CPU **101** corresponds to the control unit **12** according to the first embodiment or to the control unit **22**

according to the second embodiment. The RAM **102** or the HDD **103** corresponds to the storage unit **11** according to the first embodiment or the storage unit **21** according to the second embodiment.

(46) The CPU **101** is a processor that executes program commands. The CPU **101** executes a program by loading at least part of the programs and data stored in the HDD **103** to the RAM **102**. The CPU **101** may include a plurality of processor cores. The machine learning apparatus **100** may include a plurality of processors. A group of processors may be referred as a “multi-processor” or simply “a processor”.

(47) The RAM **102** is a volatile semiconductor memory that temporarily stores a program executed by the CPU **101** and data used by the CPU **101** for calculation. The machine learning apparatus **100** may include a different kind of memory other than a RAM or may include a plurality of memories.

(48) The HDD **103** is a non-volatile storage that stores an operating system (OS), middleware, software programs such as application software, and data. The machine learning apparatus **100** may include a different kind of storage, such as a flash memory or a solid state drive (SSD), or may include a plurality of storages.

(49) The GPU **104** outputs an image to a display device **111** connected to the machine learning apparatus **100** in accordance with a command from the CPU **101**. For example, any kind of display device may be used as the display device **111**. Examples of the display device **111** include a cathode ray tube (CRT) display, a liquid crystal display (LCD), an organic electro-luminescence (EL) display, and a projector. Other than the display device **111**, an output device such as a printer may be connected to the machine learning apparatus **100**.

(50) The input interface **105** receives an input signal from an input device **112** connected to the machine learning apparatus **100**. Any kind of input device may be used as this input device **112**. Examples of the input device include a mouse, a touch panel, a touchpad, and a keyboard. A plurality of kinds of input devices may be connected to the machine learning apparatus **100**.

(51) The media reader **106** is a reading device that reads out a program and data recorded in a recording medium **113**. Any kind of recording medium may be used as this recording medium **113**. Examples of the recording medium **113** include a magnetic disk such as a flexible disk (FD) or an HDD, an optical disc such as a compact disc (CD) or a digital versatile disc (DVD), and a semiconductor memory. For example, the media reader **106** copies the program and data read from the recording medium **113** to another recording medium such as the RAM **102** or the HDD **103**. The read program is executed by, for example, the CPU **101**. The recording medium **113** may be a portable recording medium and may be used for distribution of the program and data. The recording medium **113** and the HDD **103** may each be referred to as a computer-readable recording medium.

(52) The communication interface **107** is connected to a network **114** and communicates with other information processing apparatuses via the network **114**. The communication interface **107** may be a wired communication interface connected to a wired communication device such as a switch or a router. Alternatively, the communication interface **107** may be a wireless communication interface connected to a wireless communication device such as a base station or an access point.

(53) Next, a named entity recognition model used in the third embodiment will be described. FIG. 4 illustrates a data flow example of named entity recognition. Upon receiving text **141** written in natural language, the machine learning apparatus **100** divides a character string included in the text **141** into tokens w.sub.1, w.sub.2, w.sub.3, . . . , and w.sub.N. The character string is divided into these tokens by using a natural language processing technique such as morphological analysis. The individual token is a character string having a certain linguistic meaning and may be a word or a linguistic unit smaller than a word. The number of tokens processed at a time is N. For example, N=256. When the text **141** is long, the following processing is performed a plurality of times.

(54) The machine learning apparatus **100** converts the tokens w.sub.1, w.sub.2, w.sub.3, . . . , and w.sub.N into word vectors W.sub.1, W.sub.2, W.sub.3, . . . , and W.sub.N by converting the

individual tokens into word vectors in distributed representation. The word vectors are numerical vectors in which numerical values of a predetermined number of dimensions are listed. The number of dimensions of the word vectors is, for example, 300. The word vectors $W_{sub.1}$, $W_{sub.2}$, $W_{sub.3}$, . . . , and $W_{sub.N}$ are calculated by using a trained multi-layer neural network such as word2vec. This multi-layer neural network is generated by the following method, for example.

(55) A multi-layer neural network is prepared, and this network includes an input layer in which one node is assigned for each word that could appear in text, an output layer in which one node is assigned for each word that could appear in text, and an intermediate layer between the input layer and the output layer. A word and at least one peripheral word in a predetermined range before and after the word are extracted from sample text. Input data is a one-hot vector in which an element corresponding to a certain word is represented by “1” and elements corresponding to the other words are represented by “0”. Training data is a vector in which at least one element corresponding to a peripheral word is represented by “1” and elements corresponding to the other words are represented by “0”. The input data is given to the input layer, and an error between the output data from the output layer and the corresponding training data is calculated. The weights of edges are updated by using the backpropagation method so as to minimize the error.

(56) In this way, the multi-layer neural network for the distributed representation is generated. A feature vector that lists numerical values calculated in the intermediate layer upon entering a one-hot vector of a certain word is a word vector in distributed representation for the word. Because similar peripheral words are highly likely to appear around words having similar meanings, similar word vectors are often assigned to words having similar meanings.

(57) The machine learning apparatus **100** enters the word vectors $W_{sub.1}$, $W_{sub.2}$, $W_{sub.3}$, . . . , and $W_{sub.N}$ into BioBERT (Bidirectional Encoder Representations from Transformers for Biomedical Text Mining) **142**, to convert the word vectors $W_{sub.1}$, $W_{sub.2}$, $W_{sub.3}$, . . . , and $W_{sub.N}$ into word vectors $T_{sub.1}$, $T_{sub.2}$, $T_{sub.3}$, . . . , and $T_{sub.N}$. The BioBERT **142** is a trained multi-layer neural network generated by machine learning using text in the biomedical field as training data. The BioBERT **142** includes 24 transformer layers stacked in series. Each transformer is a multi-layer neural network that converts the input vectors into different vectors.

(58) For example, the BioBERT **142** is generated by the following method. First, a predictor is connected to the final stage of the BioBERT **142**. This predictor predicts tokens from the N vectors outputted by the last transformer. N consecutive tokens are extracted from the sample text, and N word vectors corresponding to the extracted N tokens are entered into the first transformer. However, when the N word vectors are entered, a predetermined ratio of the N tokens is masked. The word vectors corresponding to the masked tokens are set to zero vectors, for example. An error is calculated between the prediction results of the N tokens outputted from the predictor and the original N tokens before the masking, and the weights of edges are updated so as to minimize the error.

(59) Thereafter, the predictor connected to the final stage of the BioBERT **142** is changed. This predictor determines whether the latter sentence of the two sentences is related to the former sentence based on the N vectors outputted by the last transformer. Two consecutive sentences are extracted from the sample text, and word vectors corresponding to the tokens of the extracted two sentences are entered into the first transformer. The weights of edges are updated so that the predictor predicts “related”. Further, two non-consecutive sentences are extracted from the sample text, and word vectors corresponding to the tokens of the extracted two sentences are entered into the first transformer. The weights of edges are updated so that the predictor predicts “not related”. In this way, the BioBERT **142** is generated.

(60) In addition, the machine learning apparatus **100** calculates matching vectors $D_{sub.1}$, $D_{sub.2}$, $D_{sub.3}$, . . . , and $D_{sub.N}$ corresponding to the tokens $w_{sub.1}$, $w_{sub.2}$, $w_{sub.3}$, . . . , and $w_{sub.N}$, separately from the word vectors $T_{sub.1}$, $T_{sub.2}$, $T_{sub.3}$, . . . , and $T_{sub.N}$. The matching vector of an individual token is obtained by converting matching information, which

indicates a matching state between a named entity dictionary in which known named entities are listed and the token, into a vector in distributed representation. The matching vectors are calculated as follows.

(61) The machine learning apparatus **100** comprehensively generates, from the tokens $w_{sub.1}$, $w_{sub.2}$, $w_{sub.3}$, . . . , and $w_{sub.N}$, n -grams each indicating n consecutive tokens ($n=1, 2, 3, \dots$, or N). From the tokens $w_{sub.1}$, $w_{sub.2}$, $w_{sub.3}$, . . . , and $w_{sub.N}$, N 1-grams are generated, $N-1$ 2-grams are generated, and $N-2$ 3-grams are generated.

(62) The machine learning apparatus **100** performs approximate string matching between each n -gram and a named entity dictionary prepared in advance. The named entity dictionary lists the known named entities such as gene names, drug names, and disease names in the biomedical field and the classes to which the named entities belong. In the approximate string matching, the machine learning apparatus **100** calculates the edit distance (Levenshtein distance) between one named entity listed in the named entity dictionary and one n -gram. The edit distance is the number of times of addition, replacement, or deletion of one character performed to match two character strings. "Edit distance=0" means that two character strings exactly match.

(63) When the edit distance between a named entity and an n -gram is equal to or less than a predetermined threshold, the machine learning apparatus **100** determines that the named entity and the n -gram are similar to each other. If a named entity similar to an n -gram is found, the machine learning apparatus **100** generates matching information for each of the tokens included in the n -gram. The matching information includes three elements, which are a class, a matching degree, and a location.

(64) The "class" is a named entity class to which a known named entity belongs. These classes are listed in the named entity dictionary. In the third embodiment, there are four named entity classes, which are gene/protein names (Gene/Protein), drug names (Drug), disease names (Disease), and mutations (Mutation). There is another class (O: Outside) indicating that the token is not a named entity. The "matching degree" is a flag indicating whether an n -gram and a known named entity have an exact match relationship (Exact) or an approximate match relationship (Approximate). The "location" is a relative location of a target token in an n -gram. There are four types of token locations, which are single (S) in the case of a 1-gram and beginning (B), inside (I), and ending (E) in the case of a 2-gram or more.

(65) There may be two or more similar known named entities for the same n -gram. In this case, matching information is generated from each of the known named entities for the individual token included in the n -gram. In addition, when a certain token belongs to different n -grams, matching information may be generated for the token in each n -gram. Therefore, among the tokens $w_{sub.1}$, $w_{sub.2}$, $w_{sub.3}$, . . . , and $w_{sub.N}$, there are a token for which only one piece of matching information is obtained, a token for which two or more pieces of matching information are obtained, and a token for which no matching information is obtained. For the token for which no matching information is obtained, dummy matching information having "outside" as the class is given.

(66) The machine learning apparatus **100** converts each piece of matching information into a matching vector. Because there are only a few patterns (matching patterns) as different matching information, a matching pattern dictionary in which matching patterns and corresponding distributed representations are associated with each other is prepared in advance. For example, the machine learning apparatus **100** assigns an identification number to each matching pattern and generates a multi-layer neural network using these identification numbers for its input and output by performing machine learning. The machine learning apparatus **100** adopts a feature vector in which numerical values calculated in the intermediate layer when an identification number of a certain matching pattern is given to the input layer are listed as a matching vector in distributed representation corresponding to the matching pattern. The number of dimensions of the matching vector is, for example, 100. The matching vector corresponding to the individual matching

information may have a distribution in which the numerical values of a small number of dimensions are large and the numerical values of many dimensions are small.

(67) When different patterns of matching information are generated for one token, the machine learning apparatus **100** aggregates two or more matching vectors corresponding to the different matching information into one matching vector by performing pooling processing. In the pooling processing, a single vector having the same number of dimensions is generated by performing a numerical operation between two or more vectors per dimension. Examples of the pooling processing include a maximum (max) pooling and an average pooling. The max pooling is pooling processing in which a maximum numerical value is selected from among two or more vectors per dimension. The average pooling is pooling processing in which an average value of numerical values included in two or more vectors is calculated per dimension.

(68) In the third embodiment, the max pooling is adopted. When the approximate string matching is comprehensively performed between the individual n-gram of the text **141** and the named entity dictionary, miscellaneous matching information is generated, and as a result, noise is generated. In this regard, by performing the pooling processing per token, it is possible to reduce the noise while maintaining information about the dimensions that are highly likely to be related to named entity recognition. That is, useful information is compressed into a single vector of a predetermined number of dimensions.

(69) In this way, matching vectors D.sub.1, D.sub.2, D.sub.3, . . . , and D.sub.N corresponding to the tokens w.sub.1, w.sub.2, w.sub.3, . . . , and w.sub.N are calculated. The machine learning apparatus **100** combines the word vectors T.sub.1, T.sub.2, T.sub.3, . . . , and T.sub.N and the matching vectors D.sub.1, D.sub.2, D.sub.3, . . . , and D.sub.N to generate combined vectors V.sub.1, V.sub.2, V.sub.3, . . . , and V.sub.N. Per token, the matching vector is concatenated after the word vector. Thus, the number of dimensions of a combined vector is a sum of the number of dimensions of a word vector and the number of dimensions of a matching vector. For example, when a word vector has 300 dimensions and a matching vector has 100 dimensions, the combined vector has 400 dimensions.

(70) For example, by concatenating the matching vector D.sub.1 after the word vector T.sub.1, a combined vector V.sub.1 corresponding to the token w.sub.1 is generated. By concatenating the matching vector D.sub.2 after the word vector T.sub.2, a combined vector V.sub.2 corresponding to the token w.sub.2 is generated. By concatenating the matching vector D.sub.3 after the word vector T.sub.3, a combined vector V.sub.3 corresponding to the token w.sub.3 is generated. By concatenating the matching vector D.sub.N after the word vector T.sub.N, a combined vector V.sub.N corresponding to the token w.sub.N is generated.

(71) The machine learning apparatus **100** enters the combined vectors V.sub.1, V.sub.2, V.sub.3, . . . , and V.sub.N into a named entity recognition model **143** and calculates tag scores s.sub.1, s.sub.2, s.sub.3, . . . , and s.sub.N corresponding to the tokens w.sub.1, w.sub.2, w.sub.3, . . . , and w.sub.N. The tag scores include confidence factors of the respective pieces of tag information. The individual tag information indicates a class and a location such as “Gene/Protein-B” or “Drug-E”. The machine learning apparatus **100** determines tag information to be associated with each of the tokens w.sub.1, w.sub.2, w.sub.3, . . . , and w.sub.N based on the tag scores s.sub.1, s.sub.2, s.sub.3, . . . , and s.sub.N. The machine learning apparatus **100** may select, per token, tag information having the highest confidence factor among the plurality of pieces of tag information.

(72) In addition, the machine learning apparatus **100** may determine tag information for each of the tokens w.sub.1, w.sub.2, w.sub.3, . . . , and w.sub.N from the tag scores s.sub.1, s.sub.2, s.sub.3, . . . , and s.sub.N through conditional random fields (CRFs). Adjacent tokens have a dependency relationship about whether the adjacent tokens are a part of a named entity. Thus, the conditional random fields do not simply select one piece of tag information from one tag score but selects tag information in view of a dependency relationship between pieces of tag information. Upon receiving the tag scores s.sub.1, s.sub.2, s.sub.3, . . . , and s.sub.N, the conditional random fields

obtain a combination of pieces of tag information that achieves the highest probability and determines the tag information per token. The conditional random fields may be represented by a trained neural network.

(73) The named entity recognition model **143** is a multi-layer neural network. In the third embodiment, a bidirectional LSTM is used as the named entity recognition model **143**. The LSTM is a multi-layer neural network that holds an internal state. Because the internal state is held, when a plurality of input vectors are continuously entered into the LSTM, an output vector corresponding to a certain input vector is not only dependent on this input vector but also dependent on a previous input vector.

(74) The bidirectional LSTM includes a forward LSTM in which a plurality of combined vectors are entered in the forward direction (in the order of V.sub.1, V.sub.2, . . . , and V.sub.N) and a backward LSTM in which a plurality of combined vectors are entered in the backward direction (in the order of V.sub.N, V.sub.N-1, . . . , and V.sub.1). With the bidirectional LSTM, it is possible to express that a certain token is also related to a subsequent token. The bidirectional LSTM synthesizes an output vector of the forward LSTM and an output vector of the backward LSTM that correspond to the same token and calculates a final output vector for the token.

(75) The machine learning apparatus **100** generates the named entity recognition model **143** by performing machine learning using text as training data. The procedure for generating the combined vectors V.sub.1, V.sub.2, V.sub.3, . . . , and V.sub.N, which are data inputted to the named entity recognition model **143**, from the text as the training data is the same as the procedure for performing named entity recognition using the named entity recognition model **143**.

(76) The machine learning apparatus **100** enters the combined vectors V.sub.1, V.sub.2, V.sub.3, . . . , and V.sub.N into the named entity recognition model **143** and calculates an error by comparing the tag information assigned to the text as correct labels with the tag scores s.sub.1, s.sub.2, s.sub.3, . . . , and s.sub.N. The machine learning apparatus **100** updates the weights of edges, which are parameters, by using the backpropagation method so as to minimize the error. In this updating, per token, the machine learning apparatus **100** adjusts the parameters so that the confidence factor of the correct tag information indicated by the correct label becomes the highest among the confidence factors of the plurality of pieces of tag information indicated by the tag scores.

(77) Next, a specific example of calculating a matching vector for each token will be described. FIG. 5 illustrates an example of a named entity dictionary. The machine learning apparatus **100** holds the named entity dictionary **131** in advance. The named entity dictionary **131** includes a plurality of records, and a term identification (ID), a named entity, and a class are associated with each other in each record. The “term ID” is an identifier for identifying a named entity. A named entity registered in the named entity dictionary **131** is a known gene/protein name (Gene/Protein), drug name (Drug), disease name (Disease), or mutation (Mutation). One named entity may be one token or may include two or more tokens. The “class” indicates one of the above four classes.

(78) For example, a named entity #101 is “epidermal growth factor”, which is a gene/protein name. A named entity #102 is “epidermal growth factor-like 2”, which is a gene/protein name. A named entity #103 is “epidermal growth factor receptor”, which is a gene/protein name. A named entity #104 is “pro-epidermal growth factor”, which is a gene/protein name.

(79) FIG. 6 illustrates an example of a matching pattern dictionary. The machine learning apparatus **100** holds the matching pattern dictionary **132** in advance. The matching pattern dictionary **132** includes a plurality of records, and a pattern ID, a matching pattern, and a distributed representation are associated with each other in each record. The “pattern ID” is an identifier for identifying a matching pattern. The “matching pattern” indicates a matching information pattern and is obtained by concatenating three elements, which are a class, a matching degree, and a location. The class is a gene/protein name (Gene/Protein), a drug name (Drug), a disease name (Disease), a mutation (Mutation), or the others (Other). The matching degree is exact match (Exact) or approximate match (Approximate). The location is beginning (B), inside (I), ending (E), or single (S).

(80) The “distributed representation” is a matching vector obtained by vectorizing the matching pattern. In the following specific example, for ease of description, the matching vector is expressed in five dimensions. For example, matching pattern 1 is “Gene/Protein-Exact-B”, and the distributed representation thereof is (3, 2, -3, 2, 6). Matching pattern 5 is “Gene/Protein-Approximate-B”, and the distributed representation thereof is (1, 6, -1, 0, 7). Matching pattern 6 is “Gene/Protein-Approximate-I”, and the distributed representation thereof is (0, 4, 6, 3, 7).

(81) The matching pattern dictionary **132** also includes a dummy matching pattern having (Other) as the class. A pattern ID and a matching vector in distributed representation are also assigned to the dummy matching pattern.

(82) FIG. 7 illustrates a generation example of a matching vector. Text **151** includes a sentence “EGFR is epidermal growth factor receptor.” The machine learning apparatus **100** divides the text **151** into tokens **151-1** to **151-7** (“EGFR”, “is”, “epidermal”, “growth”, “factor”, “receptor”, “.”). The machine learning apparatus **100** generates n-grams with the tokens **151-1** to **151-7** and performs matching processing between each n-gram and the named entity dictionary **131**. In this example, some n-grams will be described, focusing on the token **151-3** (“epidermal”).

(83) The machine learning apparatus **100** performs approximate string matching between the 2-gram of the tokens **151-3** and **151-4** and the named entity dictionary **131**. As a result of the matching, a named entity #101 that is similar to this 2-gram is hit. The class of the named entity #101 is Gene/Protein. The token **151-3** is the beginning token. Accordingly, the machine learning apparatus **100** generates matching information “Gene/Protein-Approximate-B” for the token **151-3**.

(84) In addition, the machine learning apparatus **100** performs approximate string matching between the 3-gram of the tokens **151-3**, **151-4**, and **151-5** and the named entity dictionary **131**. As a result of the matching, a named entity #101 that completely matches this 3-gram is hit. Thus, the machine learning apparatus **100** generates matching information “Gene/Protein-Exact-B” for the token **151-3**. In addition to the named entity #101, named entities #102 and #104 that are similar to the 3-gram are hit. Thus, the machine learning apparatus **100** generates matching information “Gene/Protein-Approximate-B” from each of the named entities #102 and #104 for the token **151-3**.

(85) Further, the machine learning apparatus **100** performs approximate string matching between the 4-gram of the tokens **151-2**, **151-3**, **151-4**, and **151-5** and the named entity dictionary **131**. As a result of the matching, the named entities #102 and #104 that are similar to this 4-gram are hit. The token **151-3** is an inside token. Accordingly, the machine learning apparatus **100** generates matching information “Gene/Protein-Approximate-I” from each of the named entities #102 and #104 for the token **151-3**. In addition, the machine learning apparatus **100** performs approximate string matching between the 4-gram of the tokens **151-3**, **151-4**, **151-5**, and **151-6** and the named entity dictionary **131**. As a result of the matching, the named entity #103 that completely matches the 4-gram is hit. Thus, the machine learning apparatus **100** generates matching information “Gene/Protein-Exact-B” for the token **151-3**.

(86) As described above, three different types of matching information, which are “Gene/Protein-Exact-B”, “Gene/Protein-Approximate-B”, and “Gene/Protein-Approximate-I”, have been obtained. The machine learning apparatus **100** converts these three types of matching information into three matching vectors by referring to the matching pattern dictionary **132**. “Gene/Protein-Exact-B” corresponds to matching pattern 1 and is converted into a matching vector **152-1**. “Gene/Protein-Approximate-B” corresponds to matching pattern 5 and is converted into a matching vector **152-2**. “Gene/Protein-Approximate-I” corresponds to matching pattern 6 and is converted into a matching vector **152-3**.

(87) The machine learning apparatus **100** calculates a matching vector **153** from the matching vectors **152-1**, **152-2**, and **152-3** by performing maximum pooling. The matching vector **152-1** is (3, 2, -3, 2, 6). The matching vector **152-2** is (1, 6, -1, 0, 7). The matching vector **152-3** is (0, 4, 6, 3, 7). When the maximum value is selected per dimension, (3, 6, 6, 3, 7) is obtained as the

matching vector **153** that corresponds to the token **151-3**.

(88) FIG. **8** illustrates examples of named entity recognition results. Text **161** indicates a named entity recognition result obtained when a named entity recognition model is generated by using only the word vectors T.sub.1, T.sub.2, T.sub.3, . . . , and T.sub.N as input data without using the matching vectors D.sub.1, D.sub.2, D.sub.3, . . . , and D.sub.N. In contrast, text **162** indicates a named entity recognition result obtained by the named entity recognition model **143** illustrated in FIG. **4**.

(89) “TPM1-AS” included in the text **161** and **162** is an unknown named entity not listed in the named entity dictionary **131** and corresponds to a gene/protein name. In the named entity recognition result indicated by the text **161**, a token “TPM1” is determined to be a named entity of a single gene/protein name, and tokens “-” and “AS” are each determined to be a non-named entity. In contrast, in the named entity recognition result indicated by the text **162**, “TPM1-AS” is correctly recognized as a named entity of a string of gene/protein name. Thus, it is more likely that the named entity recognition model **143** recognizes each of the gene/protein names and drug names, which are often complex compound words, as a string of proper nouns.

(90) Next, functions of the machine learning apparatus **100** will be described. FIG. **9** is a block diagram illustrating a functional example of the machine learning apparatus. The machine learning apparatus **100** includes a text storage unit **121**, a dictionary storage unit **122**, a model storage unit **123**, a model generation unit **124**, and a named entity recognition unit **125**. The text storage unit **121**, the dictionary storage unit **122**, and the model storage unit **123** are each realized by using, for example, a storage area of the RAM **102** or the HDD **103**. The model generation unit **124** and the named entity recognition unit **125** are each realized by using, for example, a program executed by the CPU **101**.

(91) The text storage unit **121** stores text as training data. Tag information indicating named entity classes are added as correct labels to the text as training data. The text storage unit **121** also stores recognition target text. The dictionary storage unit **122** stores the named entity dictionary **131** and the matching pattern dictionary **132** described above. The model storage unit **123** stores the trained BioBERT **142**. Further, the model storage unit **123** stores the named entity recognition model **143** generated by the model generation unit **124**.

(92) The model generation unit **124** reads out the text as training data from the text storage unit **121**, reads out the named entity dictionary **131** and the matching pattern dictionary **132** from the dictionary storage unit **122**, and reads out the trained BioBERT **142** from the model storage unit **123**. The model generation unit **124** converts the read text into input data and generates the named entity recognition model **143** by performing machine learning using the input data and the correct labels. The model generation unit **124** stores the generated named entity recognition model **143** in the model storage unit **123**.

(93) The named entity recognition unit **125** reads out the recognition target text from the text storage unit **121**, reads out the named entity dictionary **131** and the matching pattern dictionary **132** from the dictionary storage unit **122**, and reads out the trained BioBERT **142** from the model storage unit **123**. The named entity recognition unit **125** converts the read text into input data. Further, the named entity recognition unit **125** reads out the trained named entity recognition model **143** from the model storage unit **123**. Next, the named entity recognition unit **125** enters the input data into the named entity recognition model **143** and generates a named entity recognition result including an individual piece of tag information associated with each token.

(94) The named entity recognition unit **125** outputs the named entity recognition result. For example, the named entity recognition unit **125** stores the named entity recognition result in a non-volatile storage. For example, the named entity recognition unit **125** displays the named entity recognition result on the display device **111**. For example, the named entity recognition unit **125** transmits the named entity recognition result to another information processing apparatus.

(95) Next, a processing procedure of the machine learning apparatus **100** will be described. FIG. **10**

is a flowchart illustrating an example of a procedure for input data generation. The following description will be made based on a case in which the model generation unit **124** generates input data. The named entity recognition unit **125** also generates input data by performing the same procedure.

(96) (S10) The model generation unit **124** converts each token into a word vector in distributed representation.

(97) (S11) The model generation unit **124** enters N word vectors corresponding to N tokens into the trained BioBERT **142** and converts the N word vectors into different N word vectors.

(98) (S12) The model generation unit **124** extracts n (n=1, 2, . . . , or N) consecutive tokens from the N tokens and comprehensively generates n-grams.

(99) (S13) The model generation unit **124** selects one n-gram from the group of n-grams generated in step S12.

(100) (S14) The model generation unit **124** searches the named entity dictionary **131** for the n-gram selected in step S13. In this case, approximate string matching is performed. The model generation unit **124** calculates the edit distance between the selected n-gram and each of the plurality of named entities included in the named entity dictionary **131** and searches for a similar named entity having the edit distance equal to or less than a threshold.

(101) (S15) If at least one similar named entity is retrieved in step S14, the model generation unit **124** generates matching information indicating {class, matching degree, location} for each token included in the n-gram selected in step S13. The class is a class to which the similar named entity belongs. The matching degree is a flag indicating whether the n-gram and the similar named entity completely match or approximately match with each other. The location is a relative location of the token in the n-gram. If two or more similar named entities are retrieved in step S14, the model generation unit **124** generates the above matching information for each of the two or more similar named entities.

(102) (S16) The model generation unit **124** determines whether all the n-grams have been selected in step S13. If all the n-grams have been selected, the processing proceeds to step S17. If there is an unselected n-gram, the processing returns to step S13.

(103) (S17) The model generation unit **124** collects the matching information having the same content per token. For a token that does not have any matching information generated in step S15, the model generation unit **124** generates dummy matching information having (Other) as the class. The model generation unit **124** refers to the matching pattern dictionary **132** and converts different pieces of matching information into respective matching vectors in distributed representation per token.

(104) (S18) The model generation unit **124** performs pooling processing for synthesizing the matching vectors per token. For a token having only one matching vector obtained in step S17, the model generation unit **124** adopts this one matching vector. For a token having two or more matching vectors obtained in step S17, the model generation unit **124** generates a single matching vector by performing an operation between numerical values of the same dimension. For example, the model generation unit **124** performs maximum pooling to select a maximum value per dimension.

(105) (S19) The model generation unit **124** generates, for each of the N tokens, a combined vector by combining the word vector generated in step S11 and the matching vector generated in step S18. The combined vector is obtained by concatenating the matching vector obtained in step S18 after the word vector obtained in step S11.

(106) FIG. **11** is a flowchart illustrating an example of a procedure for model generation. (S20) The model generation unit **124** initializes parameters of the named entity recognition model **143**. The individual parameter is the weight of an individual edge between nodes in the multi-layer neural network.

(107) (S21) The model generation unit **124** divides a character string included in text for machine

learning to which correct labels are assigned into a plurality of tokens.

(108) (S22) The model generation unit **124** performs the input data generation procedure illustrated in FIG. **10**. This generates a plurality of combined vectors corresponding to the plurality of tokens.

(109) (S23) The model generation unit **124** enters the N combined vectors into the named entity recognition model **143**. More specifically, the model generation unit **124** enters the N combined vectors into the forward LSTM sequentially from the beginning vector and enters the N combined vectors into the backward LSTM sequentially from the end vector. The named entity recognition model **143** consequently outputs N estimation results corresponding to the N combined vectors.

(110) (S24) The model generation unit **124** compares the N estimation results obtained in step S23 with the correct labels of the N tokens and calculates errors therebetween. For example, the model generation unit **124** calculates, as the error of an individual token, a numerical value by subtracting the confidence factor of the corresponding correct tag information from **1** and calculates the average of the errors of the N tokens as an overall error.

(111) (S25) The model generation unit **124** corrects the values of the parameters of the named entity recognition model **143** based on the error calculated in step S24. For example, the model generation unit **124** calculates an error gradient with respect to the parameters and changes the values of the parameters by an amount obtained by multiplying the error gradient by a predetermined learning rate. The model generation unit **124** sequentially changes the values of the parameters while propagating the error gradient from the end to the beginning of the multi-layer neural network.

(112) (S26) The model generation unit **124** determines whether a predetermined stop condition is satisfied. If steps S23 to S25 have been repeated a predetermined number of times, the model generation unit **124** may determine that the predetermined stop condition is satisfied. Further, if the error has dropped to a value equal to or less than a threshold, the model generation unit **124** may determine that the predetermined stop condition is satisfied. When the stop condition is satisfied, the processing proceeds to step S27. When the stop condition is not satisfied, the processing returns to step S23, and steps S23 to S25 are performed by using the same or different N tokens.

(113) (S27) The model generation unit **124** stores the named entity recognition model **143** including the trained parameter values in the model storage unit **123**.

(114) FIG. **12** is a flowchart illustrating an example of a procedure for named entity recognition.

(S30) The named entity recognition unit **125** reads out the trained named entity recognition model **143** from the model storage unit **123**.

(115) (S31) The named entity recognition unit **125** divides a character string included in recognition target text to which no correct labels are assigned into a plurality of tokens.

(116) (S32) The named entity recognition unit **125** performs the input data generation procedure illustrated in FIG. **10**. This generates a plurality of combined vectors corresponding to the plurality of tokens.

(117) (S33) The named entity recognition unit **125** enters the N combined vectors into the named entity recognition model **143**. More specifically, the named entity recognition unit **125** enters the N combined vectors into the forward LSTM sequentially from the beginning vector and enters the N combined vectors into the backward LSTM sequentially from the end vector. The named entity recognition model **143** consequently calculates N tag scores corresponding to the N combined vectors.

(118) (S34) The named entity recognition unit **125** generates tag information including a class estimation result for each token based on the tag scores calculated in step S33. For example, the named entity recognition unit **125** selects, for each token, tag information from which the highest confidence factor is calculated. In addition, for example, the named entity recognition unit **125** enters the N tag scores into the conditional random fields to generate a string of N pieces of tag information that maximizes the probability.

(119) (S35) The named entity recognition unit **125** outputs the named entity estimation result

obtained in step S34. For example, the named entity recognition unit **125** displays the estimation result on the display device **111**.

(120) The machine learning apparatus **100** according to the third embodiment calculates the confidence factors of the named entity classes from the vectors in distributed representation by using the named entity recognition model **143**, which is a multi-layer neural network. As a result, unknown named entities that are not listed in the named entity dictionary **131** are also recognized. In addition, matching information indicating the matching state between the named entity dictionary **131** and an n-gram is generated, vectorized, and combined with the corresponding word vectors, which is consequently inputted to the named entity recognition model **143**. As a result, named entity recognition is performed in view of the known named entities listed in the named entity dictionary **131**.

(121) In addition, in the matching processing, not only exact string matching but also approximate string matching is performed. As a result, a new named entity created by modifying a known named entity is also recognized more accurately. In particular, gene/protein names and drug names in the biomedical field are often compound words, and new similar named entities with modified endings are often created. By using the result of the approximate string matching as input, such named entities of compound words are recognized more accurately. As a result, the machine learning apparatus **100** correctly recognizes a string of a named entity made by a plurality of tokens, without splitting the named entity in the middle.

(122) Further, when approximate string matching is comprehensively performed between the named entity dictionary **131** and an n-gram, miscellaneous matching information is generated. If a large number of matching vectors corresponding to the miscellaneous matching information are directly inputted to the named entity recognition model **143**, large noise could be generated. However, the matching vectors are combined into a single vector per token by performing the pooling processing. For example, maximum pooling is performed as the pooling processing. Thus, information about the dimensions that are highly likely to contribute to improving the accuracy of the named entity recognition remains, and the noise is removed. As a result, the accuracy of the named entity recognition is improved.

(123) In one aspect, the accuracy of the named entity recognition for unknown words not listed in a dictionary is improved.

(124) All examples and conditional language provided herein are intended for the pedagogical purposes of aiding the reader in understanding the invention and the concepts contributed by the inventor to further the art, and are not to be construed as limitations to such specifically recited examples and conditions, nor does the organization of such examples in the specification relate to a showing of the superiority and inferiority of the invention. Although one or more embodiments of the present invention have been described in detail, it should be understood that various changes, replacements, and alterations could be made hereto without departing from the spirit and scope of the invention.

Claims

1. A non-transitory computer-readable recording medium storing therein a computer program that causes a computer to execute a process comprising: dividing a character string included in text data into a plurality of tokens; searching, by performing matching processing between a token string indicating a specific number of consecutive tokens among the plurality of tokens and dictionary information including a plurality of named entities and class information indicating a class for each of the plurality of named entities, the plurality of named entities for a similar named entity whose similarity to the token string is equal to or more than a threshold; converting matching information indicating a result of the matching processing between the token string and the similar named entity into first vector data, the matching information including matching degree information indicating

whether the token string and the similar named entity completely match with each other and the class information corresponding to the similar named entity, the first vector data indicating distributed representation of the matching information and including numerical values of a plurality of first dimensions; generating input data by using a plurality of pieces of second vector data converted from the plurality of tokens and the first vector data, each of the plurality of pieces of second vector data indicating distributed representation of one of the plurality of tokens and including numerical values of a plurality of second dimensions; and generating a named entity recognition model that detects a named entity by performing machine learning using the input data, the named entity recognition model being a neural network, wherein the generated named entity recognition model performs: outputting confidence factors representing probabilities, each confidence factor indicates a token belongs to one of a plurality of classes within the class information; calculating an error by comparing an output of the named entity recognition model with a corresponding correct label; and updating parameters of the named entity recognition model to minimize error and train the named entity recognition model.

2. The non-transitory computer-readable recording medium according to claim 1, wherein the searching for the similar named entity includes performing the matching processing between a different token string including a shared token also included in the token string and the dictionary information, and wherein the converting of the matching information includes generating the first vector data for the shared token by using different matching information indicating a result of the matching processing performed on the different token string and the matching information.

3. The non-transitory computer-readable recording medium according to claim 2, wherein the converting of the matching information includes converting the matching information into third vector data, converting the different matching information into different third vector data, and generating the first vector data from the third vector data and the different third vector data by performing pooling processing in which an operation is performed between elements of an identical dimension.

4. The non-transitory computer-readable recording medium according to claim 1, wherein, when two or more similar named entities are retrieved from the token string, the converting of the matching information includes converting two or more pieces of matching information corresponding to the two or more similar named entities into two or more pieces of third vector data and generating the first vector data by using the two or more pieces of third vector data.

5. The non-transitory computer-readable recording medium according to claim 1, wherein the converting of the matching information includes generating two or more pieces of matching information corresponding to two or more tokens included in the token string from a result of the matching processing and converting the two or more pieces of matching information into two or more pieces of first vector data, and wherein the generating of the named entity recognition model includes synthesizing one of the plurality of pieces of second vector data and one of the two or more pieces of first vector data that correspond to an identical token.

6. The non-transitory computer-readable recording medium according to claim 5, wherein each of the two or more pieces of matching information includes location information indicating a relative location of a token in the token string, the token being corresponding to the each of the two or more pieces of matching information.

7. A machine learning method comprising: dividing, by a processor, a character string included in text data into a plurality of tokens; searching, by the processor, by performing matching processing between a token string indicating a specific number of consecutive tokens among the plurality of tokens and dictionary information including a plurality of named entities and class information indicating a class for each of the plurality of named entities, the plurality of named entities for a similar named entity whose similarity to the token string is equal to or more than a threshold; converting, by the processor, matching information indicating a result of the matching processing between the token string and the similar named entity into first vector data, the matching

information including matching degree information indicating whether the token string and the similar named entity completely match with each other and the class information corresponding to the similar named entity, the first vector data indicating distributed representation of the matching information and including numerical values of a plurality of first dimensions; generating, by the processor, input data by using a plurality of pieces of second vector data converted from the plurality of tokens and the first vector data, each of the plurality of pieces of second vector data indicating distributed representation of one of the plurality of tokens and including numerical values of a plurality of second dimensions; and generating a named entity recognition model that detects a named entity by performing machine learning using the input data, the named entity recognition model being a neural network, wherein the generated named entity recognition model performs: outputting confidence factors representing probabilities, each confidence factor indicates a token belongs to one of a plurality of classes within the class information; calculating an error by comparing an output of the named entity recognition model with a corresponding correct label; and updating parameters of the named entity recognition model to minimize error and train the named entity recognition model.

8. A named entity recognition apparatus comprising: a memory configured to store dictionary information including a plurality of named entities and class information indicating a class for each of the plurality of named entities, and a named entity recognition model; and a processor configured to execute a process including: dividing a character string included in text data into a plurality of tokens, searching, by performing matching processing between a token string indicating a specific number of consecutive tokens among the plurality of tokens and dictionary information, the plurality of named entities for a similar named entity whose similarity to the token string is equal to or more than a threshold, converting matching information indicating a result of the matching processing between the token string and the similar named entity into first vector data, the matching information including matching degree information indicating whether the token string and the similar named entity completely match with each other and the class information corresponding to the similar named entity, the first vector data indicating distributed representation of the matching information and including numerical values of a plurality of first dimensions, generating input data by using a plurality of pieces of second vector data converted from the plurality of tokens and the first vector data, each of the plurality of pieces of second vector data indicating distributed representation of one of the plurality of tokens and including numerical values of a plurality of second dimensions, and generating a named entity recognition model that detects a named entity by performing machine learning using the input data, the named entity recognition model being a neural network, wherein the generated named entity recognition model performs: outputting confidence factors representing probabilities, each confidence factor indicates a token belongs to one of a plurality of classes within the class information; calculating an error by comparing an output of the named entity recognition model with a corresponding correct label; and updating parameters of the named entity recognition model to minimize error and train the named entity recognition model.
